Multipurpose Vat



Category: **Animal Husbandry & Dairy** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Multipurpose Stainless Steel Vat

What it is used for

A multipurpose stainless steel vat holds, mixes or processes liquids and food materials in dairy operations. Its use depends on the design and whether heating, cooling or agitation is provided.

Main parts

- Identify the stainless steel vessel and its intended working capacity.
- Locate the inlet, outlet valve and drain arrangement, where fitted.
- Identify the lid or cover and its securing arrangement.
- Locate the support frame, legs and any lifting handles.
- Identify the agitator, motor or mixing shaft, if provided.
- Locate temperature indicators, heating or cooling connections, where fitted.
- Identify seals, gaskets and other removable food-contact components.

Before you start

1. Confirm the vat is suitable for the intended food or dairy process.
2. Wash and sanitise all food-contact surfaces using approved procedures.
3. Inspect the vessel, welds, valves, seals and supports for damage or leaks.
4. Ensure the vat is stable and its outlet valve is closed before filling.
5. Check that heating, cooling or agitation systems are correctly connected, if present.
6. Wear clean protective clothing and prepare suitable heat-resistant PPE when needed.

How to use

1. Place the vat on a stable, level surface with adequate working clearance.
2. Confirm that the drain and outlet valve are correctly closed.
3. Add the required material without exceeding the marked or recommended capacity.
4. Secure the lid where required while allowing designed vents to remain unobstructed.
5. Operate the mixing, heating or cooling system only if fitted and required.
6. Monitor the contents and temperature using the provided controls or instruments.
7. Avoid sudden filling, splashing or mixing speeds that cause overflow.
8. Stop agitation and isolate power before opening or emptying where required.
9. Drain or transfer the contents through the designated outlet into a suitable container.
10. Clean and sanitise the vat promptly after the process is complete.

⚠ Safety

- Never exceed the rated capacity or operating temperature of the vat.
- Avoid contact with hot surfaces, steam and heated liquids.
- Keep hands away from agitators and mixing shafts while operating.
- Isolate electrical and heating supplies before maintenance or internal cleaning.
- Do not enter the vat or lean inside while equipment is operating.
- Use suitable lifting assistance when moving heavy or filled vessels.

Care & storage

- Wash away product residue and sanitise food-contact surfaces after use.
- Clean valves, seals and outlet fittings without damaging their surfaces.
- Inspect welds, gaskets, supports and connections regularly for leaks or wear.
- Store the clean vat dry with its lid protected from contamination.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Filling beyond capacity and causing spills during mixing or heating.
- Using a vat with damaged seals, valves or unstable supports.
- Operating an agitator while hands or cleaning tools are inside.
- Assuming every vat is designed for heating, pressure or cooling.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.